An application piece by Hemanth Vallamkonda for the AI Enablement Partner role at Janus Henderson Investors, in the Innovation team of the Corporate, CFO division. [S1]

# Worth pursuing? AI or better process? Whose build?

Your advert asks the AI Business Partner to help teams “quickly assess which AI opportunities are worth pursuing, how they can scale, and the best route to delivery”. This is that assessment as a working desk. It gives a first view for the Partner and the ATC to challenge, with its rules in the open and the Microsoft 365 build that would run it. [S1]

The AI Academy reports adoption at around 86% and says the challenge “has shifted from access to depth”. More adoption means more ideas arriving at the Partner's desk. [S4]

Illustrative: the desk's first view on eight typical ideas from an asset manager's corporate and distribution teams. Only three go straight to an AI build.

| Process first | Use what already exists | Business users | AI Business Partner | Process automation team | Technology | External partner or vendor product |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 1 | 1 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 1 |

## The desk

Your Forward Deployed Engineering advert describes the split: Enablement Partners “surface and triage demand”, and engineers build what business units “cannot stand up alone”. This desk is the triage half. [S3]

The printed version shows the desk's verdict for the first idea; the table after the board shows all eight.
Rules are checked in order and the first match decides the route. Nothing here decides on its own: the Partner confirms or overrides every route.

Illustrative ideas and hours. Not Janus Henderson's backlog.

Month-end variance commentary

Verdict

## Process first, then re-run

- **Process first**
- Use what already exists
- Business users
- AI Business Partner
- Process automation team
- Technology
- External partner or vendor product

**Process first.** The business unit, convened by the ATC; the AI Business Partner facilitates.

Decided by rule D3: the first fix is process: nobody owns the rule, or inputs arrive in different shapes.

> **Once the process is in place**
> AI Business Partner, tier 2. Pursue: worth a pilot. A Copilot Studio agent with an agent flow for the multi-step parts, or another platform approved for this data class.

| | |
|---|---|
| AI or process | **Process first, then AI.** Standardise the input first, then let AI handle the variation that remains. The first step is agreeing a template, not building a tool. |
| Measure | **Hours saved.** Time log on the next 10 instances before anything is built (about two weeks). The same log in week 4 of the pilot. Hours saved = (baseline minutes minus pilot minutes) x monthly volume. |
| Hours at stake | 25 h a month spent today. Not hours saved: those are measured in the pilot. |
| People | The ATC convenes the decision on the owner or the template. No tool training yet. |

Controls, once it is built

| | |
|---|---|
| Control | **Tier 2: checklist review.** Technology and the data owner sign a short checklist before the pilot. |
| Human gate | The reviewer signs off the document, as today. |

Rules that fired

- **R3 AI or process.** Standardise the input first, then let AI handle the variation that remains. The first step is agreeing a template, not building a tool.
- **T2 Control tier.** Confidential internal data, or output that feeds a team document or decision.
- **D3 Route to delivery.** The first step is process, not technology. Re-run the desk once the owner, rule or input standard is agreed.
- **V2 Worth pursuing.** Value 5 (hours 3, reach 2) against effort 4 (systems 2, tier 2 review 1, licences or capacity 1).

# Eight ideas, seven destinations

The same eight ideas, placed where the desk sends them. Illustrative.

Of the eight, two are not AI problems today: one needs its input standardised first and one is a rules-based flow. One may already be covered by a firm-wide programme. Three go straight to an AI build by business users or the AI Business Partner, and two go to Forward Deployed Engineering or the Buy workstream, with the Partner as product owner.

Illustrative: the desk's first view for each of the eight ideas

| Idea | First view: route, tier, AI or process | Measure | Verdict |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Month-end variance commentary** FP&A | **Process first**, tier 2. Process first, then AI. Once the process is in place: AI Business Partner, tier 2. | Hours saved | Process first, then re-run |
| **Weekly tax and regulatory update digest** Tax | **Business users**, tier 1. AI fits. | Hours saved | Pursue now |

| Idea | First view: route, tier, AI or process | Measure | Verdict |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Expense and travel policy questions**<br>Finance operations | **AI Business Partner**, tier 1. AI fits. | Hours saved | Pursue now |
| **Audit and control evidence requests**<br>Finance control | **AI Business Partner**, tier 3. AI fits. | Risk reduction percentage | Pursue now |
| **Daily corporate cash position**<br>Corporate treasury | **Process automation team**, tier 2. Automation, not AI. | Risk reduction percentage | Pursue: worth a pilot |
| **Client report commentary checks**<br>Client reporting | **Technology**, tier 3. AI fits. | Risk reduction percentage | Worth it: start with a smaller first slice |
| **Supplier contract obligations register**<br>Procurement | **External partner or vendor product**, tier 2. AI fits. | Risk reduction percentage | Pursue: worth a pilot |
| **Client meeting briefing packs**<br>Distribution | **Use what already exists**, tier 3. AI fits. | Revenue growth | Hold: check what already exists |

# The rules, in plain English

Every rule is written down so ATCs and control partners can check it. The page runs on the same file you can download: change the file and the desk changes.

The tiers follow the FCA's good-practice note of 19 October 2026: existing rules apply to AI, and firms do well with “simpler risk tiers” that add testing, guardrails and monitoring as risk rises. [S10]

## Route to delivery: the first rule that matches wins

1. **Use what already exists** when a firm-wide programme may already cover it. No second version of a firm-wide build.
2. **Use what already exists** when a tool the firm already owns may do it. Check the AI features of what the firm already owns first.
3. **Process first** when the first fix is process: nobody owns the rule, or inputs arrive in different shapes. Agree the owner, rule or input standard, then re-run the desk.
4. **External partner or vendor product** when the capability is not available in-house. Usually a purchase through the Buy workstream, with vendor due diligence.
5. **Technology** when it needs core platform integration or writes to a system of record. Escalated demand goes to Forward Deployed Engineering.
6. **Process automation team** when it is deterministic work on structured data. A flow, not a model.
7. **Business users** when one person or one team, all users licensed, Microsoft 365 only, tier 1 or 2, and the output stays with the user or team. A tested pattern in users' own hands.
8. **AI Business Partner** when anything else that is an AI build. The Partner builds it and hands it to a Fighter Pilot.

## Control tier: set by data and destination, never by the model

- **Tier 3: full control review.** Client, personal or market-sensitive data (or data nobody has labelled yet), or output that goes to the board, auditors, regulators or clients, or into a system of record. Technology, AI Governance, Information Security and Compliance or Risk review before the build; a named approver for every output; logging on.
- **Tier 2: checklist review.** Confidential internal data, or output that feeds a team document or decision. Technology and the data owner sign a short checklist before the pilot.
- **Tier 1: notify only.** Internal, non-sensitive data used in the person's own work. A register entry on a pre-approved pattern; no review meeting.

### Added on top of the tier, where they apply

- DPIA screening with the Data Protection Officer before any personal data is processed.
- Compliance confirms information-barrier and insider-list controls (UK MAR) before build.
- The data owner labels the source data first; until then it is treated as tier 3.
- Oversharing check on the SharePoint sites the agent will ground on: permissions and sensitivity labels reviewed first.
- Financial promotion sign-off where the output is marketing; a Consumer Duty check where retail clients will see it.
- The accountable owner signs the final version, and that version is kept for the record.
- An accountable Senior Manager is named in the register (SM&CR).

## Worth pursuing: transparent arithmetic

Value is hours at stake (under 5 hours a month scores 1; under 20, 2; under 80, 3; more, 4) plus reach (one person 1 up to most of the firm 4) plus the benefit chosen (quality, risk or revenue 1, and quality or risk at tier 3 a further 1).

Effort is the connection (Microsoft 365 only 1; an allowed connector 2; a premium connector or a bought product 3; core platforms 4) plus review load (tier 2 adds 1, tier 3 adds 2) plus 1 where users lack Copilot licences, minus 1 where a pattern already exists.

Effort of 6 or more: start with a smaller first slice. Value at least effort plus 3: pursue now. At least effort plus 1: worth a pilot. Otherwise it is logged and rechecked.

# The first 90 days in a unit, with one idea carried end to end

Month-end variance commentary is the thread: it starts as a process question, becomes an AI Business Partner build, and leaves a pattern behind for the next unit. Variance analysis and monthly packs appear in the firm's own FP&A adverts; everything else here is illustrative. [S6] The line under each step is what runs alongside it in the unit.

**Illustrative plan. Steps and timings would be agreed with the unit lead.**

**Weeks 1 and 2**

### Register and triage

The desk goes live beside the Use Case Library. Variance commentary comes out as process first: the reasons behind each variance arrive in different forms. A time log on the next close sets the baseline.

The ATC and I triage the existing ideas and any personal builds already in use, without blame.

**Weeks 3 and 4**

### Standardise the input

The FP&A lead and budget holders agree a short reason template captured with the figures. The desk is re-run: AI Business Partner, tier 2. The benefit owner signs a value case in hours.

The first self-serve pattern, a weekly digest prompt, goes into the Prompt Library with a Fighter Pilot as owner.

**Weeks 5 and 6**

### Build with a Fighter Pilot

A Copilot Studio agent and a Power Automate flow draft commentary from the agreed reasons and the period's figures. The flow checks every figure in a draft against the source extract. It is built as a solution in a managed environment, with the tier 2 checklist signed.

Test set: the commentary from the last three closes, scored on the agreed rubric.

**Weeks 7 and 8**

### Parallel run, with a kill criterion

The pilot runs alongside the normal process for one close. Analysts edit and approve every line, and the time log is repeated. If verified hours fall below the floor agreed with the FP&A lead, or an unchecked figure reaches a draft, it stops for rework.

Adoption: short sessions built on the unit's own examples, run by the Fighter Pilot.

**Weeks 9 and 10**

### Go live and hand over

The ATC and the FP&A lead agree go-live. The Fighter Pilot becomes owner, connections move to a service account, and the benefit owner signs the first verified hours.

The ATC takes the monthly benefit check and the register into the monthly ATC catch-up.

**Weeks 11 and 12**

### Publish, then rotate

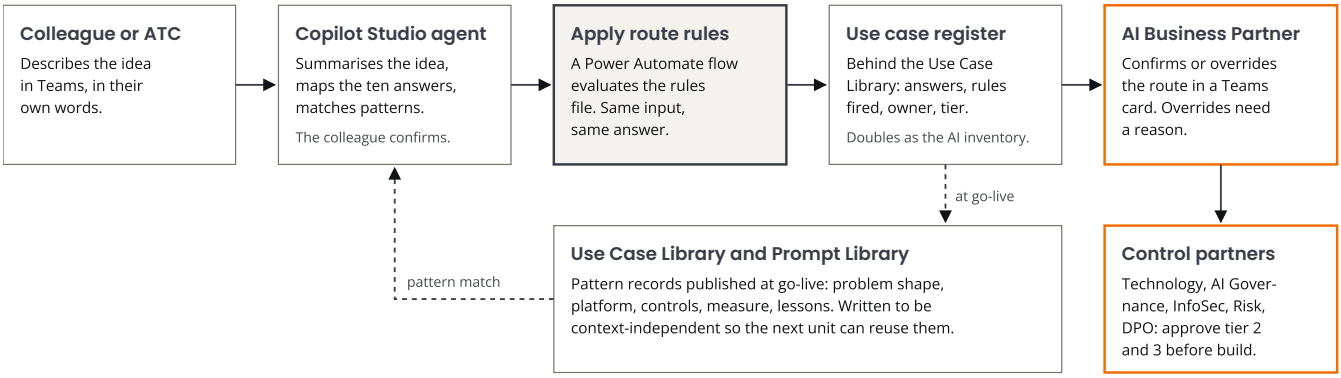
The pattern record goes into the Use Case Library: problem shape, controls, measure and lessons, written so another unit can use it without me.

The next unit inherits the desk, the register and the pattern.

## How the desk would run inside Microsoft 365

Your advert names Copilot Studio and Power Automate as today's toolkit and calls the strategy platform-agnostic. The firm has also announced Claude and Cowork for staff, and its engineering adverts describe its own agentic workspace for citizen developers and a central MCP server for governed access to enterprise data. So the desk names approved platforms by zone and data class, not one vendor. [S1] [S2] [S5]

The three delivery zones are Microsoft's own: citizen development, partnered development with a coach and IT approval to publish, and professional development. The intake agent follows Microsoft's canonical pattern for an intake and routing agent: collect the information, apply predefined routing logic, hand over, and never improvise a resolution. [S7] [S8]




### AI drafts and matches

It summarises the idea, suggests answers, finds similar patterns and drafts the pattern record. It never sets the route or the tier.

### Rules route

Route, tier, priority and controls come from the rules file, so every decision can be explained and the same idea always gets the same first view.

### People decide

The colleague confirms the summary, the Partner confirms or overrides the route, control partners approve, and the benefit owner signs the hours.

## The build pack

Drafted for a Microsoft 365 tenant from public Microsoft documentation. Not tested in a Janus Henderson environment.

| | |
|---|---|
| route-rules.json | The rules this page runs on: questions, routes, tiers, controls and priority. Edit it to change the desk. |
| engine.mjs | The evaluator the page runs: dependency-free JavaScript that reads the rules file and returns route, tier, controls, measure and the rules that fired. |
| agent-instructions.md | Instructions, topics and guardrails for the Copilot Studio intake agent. |
| harness-flow.md | The Power Automate harness: trigger, rule evaluation, register write, the Partner's card, approvals, audit fields and failure handling. |
| register-schema.csv | Columns for the use case register (behind the Use Case Library, or a new SharePoint list), which doubles as the AI inventory. |

| | |
|---|---|
| route-card.json | The Adaptive Card the Partner receives in Teams to confirm or override a route, filled in for one idea. |

# Hours at stake are not hours saved

The advert names four measures: hours saved, quality improvement scores, risk reduction percentages and revenue growth. Each needs a baseline taken before anything is built, and someone other than the builder to confirm it. [S1]

Reported time savings are weak evidence on their own. The UK government's Copilot evaluation "did not find evidence that time savings have led to improved productivity", and Microsoft calls its own assisted-hours figures broad approximations. The Academy already separates adoption, "a prerequisite", from value, "the goal"; the desk does the same, tracking routine use apart from the four measures below. [S11] [S9] [S4]

How each measure is taken

| Measure | Baseline, before anything is built | In the pilot | Who confirms | What it avoids |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Hours saved** | Time log on the next 10 instances before anything is built (about two weeks). | The same log in week 4 of the pilot. Hours saved = (baseline minutes minus pilot minutes) x monthly volume. | The benefit owner signs the figure. | Avoids counting hours at stake, self-reported estimates or tool-estimated assisted hours as hours saved. |
| **Quality improvement score** | Score 10 recent outputs on a short rubric: accuracy, completeness, tone, edits needed. | Score 10 pilot outputs on the same rubric, blind to which is which. | The usual reviewer scores; the ATC keeps the sheet. | Avoids judging quality by how the tool feels to use. |
| **Risk reduction percentage** | Count the errors or exceptions per month that reach review or leave the team. | The same count during the pilot, reported as a percentage with the counts beside it. | The control owner confirms the counts. | Avoids a percentage with no denominator. |

| Measure | Baseline, before anything is built | In the pilot | Who confirms | What it avoids |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Revenue growth** | Record the leading measure the idea moves first, such as response turnaround or capacity. | Track the leading measure in the pilot; review win rate quarterly with the commercial owner. | The commercial owner agrees how revenue is attributed before any is claimed. | Avoids crediting AI with revenue that markets or the sales team earned. |

# Where I have done parts of this

None of this was at an asset manager; these are the closest parallels.

### A tool the team runs itself

At MTest Labs, a software-testing firm, I built an internal tool with a staged, multi-agent flow grounded in the firm's own test-case library. Test design fell from an 8-hour day, or 2 to 3 days on larger projects, to 1 to 3 supervised hours. A tester approves every case, and I trained the team to run it.

### Routing and triage redesigned before automating

At Bnk To The Future, a regulated investment platform, I redesigned case routing, triage and escalation across 100+ cases, with ~25% faster turnaround, and prepared the monthly management and risk-committee reporting.

### Low-risk steps run alone, consequential ones stay supervised

At Atelier di Venice I automated dozens of workflows across operations, marketing and finance, from first enquiry to delivery, with an autonomy boundary that keeps client and financial steps under human review.

### Finance reporting, measured

At Kuruvella & Co. I built Excel dashboards and VBA macros that cut report preparation time by ~35% across 30+ SME client entities.

Toolkit in use: Copilot Studio, Power Automate, Microsoft 365, Claude, and n8n for over a year. Certified in Microsoft Azure AI Fundamentals (AI-900).

# Sources

Public pages only, accessed 3 November 2026. Quotations are exact.

**S1** Janus Henderson, AI Enablement Partner (London), advert, division Corporate, CFO. Posted 22 Oct 2026. jobs.janushenderson.com (https://jobs.janushenderson.com/job/London-AI-Enablement-Partner-EC2M-3AE/1422856600/)

**S2** Janus Henderson press release on the Percepta build with Anthropic's Claude (PRISM, LIBROS, Claude Code and Cowork). 11 Jun 2026. janushenderson.com (https://www.janushenderson.com/corporate/press-releases/janus-henderson-and-general-catalysts-percepta-build-ai-native-investment-and-client-tools-powered-by-anthropics-claude/)

**S3** Janus Henderson, Senior Forward Deployed Engineer (London), advert. Posted 15 Oct 2026. jobs.janushenderson.com (https://jobs.janushenderson.com/job/London-Senior-Forward-Deployed-Engineer-EC2M-3AE/1440349700/)

**S4** Janus Henderson, Head of AI Academy (London), advert. Posted 7 Oct 2026. jobs.janushenderson.com (https://jobs.janushenderson.com/job/London-Head-of-AI-Academy-EC2M-3AE/1437643700/)

**S5** Janus Henderson, AI Governance Engineering Lead (London), advert. Posted 17 Oct 2026. jobs.janushenderson.com (https://jobs.janushenderson.com/job/London-AI-Governance-Engineering-Lead-EC2M-3AE/1431376600/)

**S6** Janus Henderson, Senior FP&A Analyst (Forecasting and Consolidation), London, advert. The role is now filled; the text is quoted from an archived copy. Archived copy (https://jobs.workable.com/jobs/af6cdeb5-213d-46c6-b182-5a10000258a6.md); original listing (https://jobs.janushenderson.com/job/London-Senior-FP&A-Analyst-%28ForecastingConsolidation%29-EC2M-3AE/1399722100/).

**S7** Microsoft Learn, Implement a zoned governance strategy (Copilot Studio). Updated 15 Oct 2026. learn.microsoft.com (https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/guidance/sec-gov-phase2)

**S8** Microsoft Learn, Compare Copilot Studio agent harnesses. 30 Sep 2026. learn.microsoft.com (https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/guidance/choose-harness)

**S9** Microsoft Learn, Copilot Dashboard in Viva Insights (assisted hours). 29 Sep 2026. learn.microsoft.com (https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/viva/insights/org-team-insights/copilot-dashboard)

**S10** FCA, AI in financial services: good practice and areas for improvement. 19 Oct 2026. fca.org.uk (https://www.fca.org.uk/publications/good-poor-practice/ai-financial-services)

**S11** Department for Business and Trade, Microsoft 365 Copilot evaluation. Aug 2025. gov.uk (https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/68adbe409e1cebdd2c96a19d/dbt-microsoft-365-copilot-evaluation.pdf)

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